

Parks Board Meeting October 21, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=01nGloG6vEA
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Muncie Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: October 21, 2024

Location: City of Muncie Municipal Building

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting to order on Tuesday, October 21, 2024 [00:00:04](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** James Lutton, Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall, Chandra Parks, and Mark Irvin (noted during roll call and subsequent discussion).
 - **Members Absent:** (None explicitly stated as absent during roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (implied by directing meeting flow and motions).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:08](#).
 - Moment of silence and remembrance held for Tristan Goodman, a dedicated Muncie parks staff member at Prairie Creek who passed away the previous week [00:00:38](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the September meeting were approved by voice vote with no discussion or revisions [00:01:26](#).

3. Superintendent Report

- **Presenter:** Carl Malone, Parks Superintendent 00:01:40.
- **Operations & Maintenance Update:**
 - Winterization is nearly complete across most parks, with minor plumbing lines remaining at Riverview (delayed due to a new restroom installation), Two East, and Thomas Park 00:03:05.
 - Mowing season is slowing down, transitioning into fall maintenance projects: trimming, mulching, pruning, tree removal, and playground equipment safety inspections 00:03:52.
 - Pickleball nets at Riverview will be taken in for the season 00:04:42.
 - Tu Pool shade structures are being evaluated for replacement due to fraying 00:05:22. Power washing and painting are underway at the Tu Pool entryway and lifeguard areas 00:06:01.
 - Tu Pool tennis court will be repaved in early spring as a combined tennis/pickleball court with lighting and safety structures 00:06:44.
 - Dog park line quotes are being gathered (\$3,000<U+2013>\$5,000 range) for installation before weather changes 00:07:18.
 - New park signage is arriving and will be installed across several parks; the Hackley & 9th sign framework (\$5,000<U+2013>\$6,000) is slated for the new budget year 00:07:41.
 - Thomas Park restroom renovations are targeted for completion in November 00:08:17. Playground mulch quotes for Thomas Park are around \$12,000<U+2013>\$14,000 00:08:59.
 - Westside basketball court repaving has completed the permitting paperwork process, awaiting final feedback 00:09:16.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:10:14 **Presentation: Westside Skate Park Legal Graffiti Wall & Alternative Projects**
 - **Presenter:** Caleb Schwarz (Ball State University senior urban planning student).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Schwarz provided an update on the Westside Skate Park legal graffiti wall project. Despite broad community support (Mayor, Ball State President, Architecture Dean, Muncie Arts Council), a pre-grant meeting with the George and Francis Ball Foundation was cancelled because the project is not a top priority for the mayor's office. Project installation costs are estimated between \$20,000 and \$30,000.
 - **Alternative Proposal:** With \$1,160 in community-raised funds currently held by the Student Planning Association, Schwarz proposed transferring funds to the Muncie Delaware County Community Foundation to purchase a permanent water fountain

for the skate park (requiring separate plumbing work), with remaining funds supporting a summer skate camp.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote required; the board consensus supported coordinating the fund transfer for a skate park water fountain and future programming.
- **00:16:53 Presentation: Flatland Resources <U+2013> Prairie Creek Multi-Use Trail (Phase 3)**
 - **Presenter:** David Hleman (Flatland Resources).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Hleman presented phase three of the multi-use trail at Prairie Creek Reservoir, a 6,100-foot ADA-compliant stone path connecting phase two to the beach house. Total project cost is estimated at \$370,000, funded by a \$266,000 DNR Indiana Trails Program (ITP) grant, a \$40,000 Ball Brothers Foundation grant, and local cost-saving measures (sourcing fill dirt locally near the maintenance facility to save \$40,000), leaving a \$19,000 city match. Board members raised concerns regarding safety and shared vehicular traffic at the second inlet bridge crossing and requested clarification on funding sources and long-term maintenance costs (\$5,000<U+2013>\$8,000 annually).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled until next month to allow the engineer to provide further details on bridge safety, design, and mayoral funding commitments for the city match **00:45:13**.
- **00:47:18 Programming & Event Approvals**
 - **Presenter:** Nikki (Parks Staff).
 - **Upcoming Staff Events:**
 - Trunk or Treat: Saturday, Oct 27, 6:00 PM <U+2013> 8:00 PM at Heekin Park basketball courts, featuring a Halloween egg hunt, face painting, bounce houses, food, and raffles **00:47:37**.
 - Winter Coat/Wear Drive: Partnering with Walmart South on November 4th to collect new/gently used winter items for the unhoused population **00:48:58**.
 - **Event Approval 1:** Ashley Duke LLC <U+2013> Football Combine, Flag Football, and Halloween Party **00:49:46**
 - *Details:* McCulloch Park grassy area and basketball courts, November 1st (9:00 AM <U+2013> 4:00 PM combine/football; 7:00 PM <U+2013> 10:00 PM party), expecting ~75 youth, free of charge, with security and food provided.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Voice Vote **00:51:28**.
 - **Event Approval 2:** Prevent Child Abuse of Delaware County <U+2013> 5K Run **00:53:29**
 - *Details:* Tu Park, November 15th, 8:30 AM <U+2013> 2:00 PM, expecting ~200 participants, benefiting a local Safe Haven Baby Box. The board noted portable restrooms will be provided since park restrooms will be winterized.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Voice Vote **00:53:34**.
- **01:06:45 Prairie Creek Campsite Non-Renewal Appeals Discussion**

- **Presenter:** Board Members & Carl Malone.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed the upcoming appeal process for campsite non-renewals issued primarily based on Board of Health reports, security issues, and repeat offenses. Appeals are due November 15th [01:11:46](#). Initial reviews will be conducted in an executive session in early December (pending exact date selection, with December 2nd or 9th as leading options), followed by individual votes during the public December meeting using anonymized identifiers [01:07:25](#). Board members debated whether leaseholders should be permitted in-person speaking time during the appeals process.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote taken; administrative staff will ensure all leaseholders receive clear notification and appeal paperwork.
- [01:24:45](#) **New Business: Prairie Creek Administration Building Usage**
 - **Presenter:** James Lutton & Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Board members discussed the underutilization and high utility/maintenance costs of the large Prairie Creek administration building, noting that the upstairs has been vacant and the downstairs houses limited staff. Suggestions included reviving upper-level commercial/restaurant/banquet leasing or relocating boat launch fee collection back to the ramp area.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Discussion item only; no formal action taken. Board consensus agreed to further review Prairie Creek operational expenses and facility utilization.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:18:04](#) **Charles Allen:** Spoke in favor of allowing campsite leaseholders to speak publicly during their appeal process to properly explain their individual situations.
 - [01:18:47](#) **Tammy Als:** Asked for clarification on the criteria used to issue non-renewal letters, inquiring whether a threshold (such as three or more violations) was applied.
 - [01:21:45](#) **Mike Foster:** Suggested addressing the Prairie Creek wastewater holding tank sizing issue by immediately designing for a larger capacity (e.g., 200+ spots) rather than waiting for exact numbers, and supported in-person appeals for campers.
 - [01:21:48](#) **Rod Whage:** Expressed long-standing concerns regarding large powerboats and wakeboarding damaging lake habitats, eroding banks, and creating safety hazards on the small reservoir. Also questioned the financial uncertainty surrounding the Phase 3 trail bridge engineering costs.
 - [01:34:06](#) **Unnamed Resident:** Inquired about the operational status of the campground electronic security gates and key fobs, which remain non-functional after significant expenditures. Carl Malone and staff noted security contractors are working through system kinks.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff/Board Announcements:** Prairie Creek management (Misty and Tonnie) are conducting interviews, preparing dock pier removal, and engaging with campers to build positive rapport. A second stakeholder meeting with Indiana American Water is anticipated.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [01:36:54](#).

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